



Score Board for MFDs

MFDs	Scanner Optical Resolution	Type of cartridges	Fax	PictBridge/Mem. Card Reader	Tray Capacity (In/out)	LCD Screen/ Type	Overall Score (Out of 100)	Price (Rs)
Office MFDs								
Brother MFC-210C	1200x1200	CMYK(4)	Yes	No/Yes	100/25	Yes/B/W	50.16	9900
Brother MFC-3240C	1200x6000	CMYK(4)	Yes	No/No	20/50	Yes/B/W	50.83	9900
Epson Stylus CX1500	600x1200	B/W and Color	No	No/No	100/50	No	33.14	5695
HP PSC 1608	1200x4800	B/W and Color	No	No/Yes	100/50	Yes/B/W	53.26	11700
HP Officejet 4255	600x1200	B/W and Color	Yes	No/No	100/20	Yes/B/W	48.01	7999
HP Officejet 5510	600x1200	B/W and Color	Yes	No/No	100/50	Yes/B/W	43.81	12499
HP PSC 2310	1200x2400	B/W and Color	Yes	No/Yes	150/50	Yes/B/W	53.58	11499
Lexmark X7170	1200x4800	B/W and Color	Yes	Yes/No	100/25	Yes/B/W	63.33	14999
Photo MFDs								
Epson Photo RX630	2400x4800	CMYK (6)	No	Yes/Yes	120/20	Yes/Color	43.96	24295
HP Photosmart 2608	2400x4800	B/W and Color	Yes	Yes/Yes	150/50	Yes/Color	55.33	14999
Lexmark P6250	1200x2400	CMYK (6)	No	Yes/Yes	100/25	Yes/Color	49.7	12999

For the complete scoreboard, log on to www.thinkdigit.com

The same is true for the combi-doc, where the HP 2608 printer took a mere 31 seconds as compared to 39 for the Epson RX630 and 70 for the Lexmark P6250. Again, in the photo test, the HP printer did the job in 263 seconds, while the Epson RX630 took a whopping 473.81 seconds and the Lexmark P 6250 took 312 seconds, nearly 50 per cent more time! In this section, the focus is more on quality than speed.

In terms of text quality, the HP 2608 and Lexmark P6250 tied, leaving us with more tests to do.

In the image and combi-doc quality, HP PhotoSmart 2608 was significantly better than the others, though Lexmark P6250 did give HP 2608 a pretty tough run for its money.

Scanning

In the scanner tests, the procedure was no different, and HP PhotoSmart 2608 simply outclassed the rest by detecting all 22 shades of black with amazing clarity. The Epson could detect only 20 while the Lexmark P6250 detected 19.

In the resolution tests, the HP PhotoSmart 2608 again detected all three boxes whereas the Lexmark detected only two. The Epson could detect all three, but only when scanned at full colour resolution at the highest possible bit depth.

The HP was also the fastest scanner and the only one that could read 3/5 squares in the reso-

lution card. Epson and Lexmark detected only two boxes. This proved their native scanning capabilities were not as good as those of the HP 2608. So, if you want to scan fast and accurately, go for HP.

Copying

For these photo MFDs, the copier test was the same as before, and here as well, the HP PhotoSmart 2608 came out tops with the most vivid colour and print quality of the copied document.

The speed of the HP PhotoSmart 2608 in copying documents, especially B&W ones, was sensational. It took 17 seconds to copy a B&W document, as compared to the 37 and 41 seconds taken by the Lexmark P6250 and the Epson RX630 respectively.

In colour copying, the HP PhotoSmart 2608 and the Lexmark P6250 tied in terms of speed, with both taking 39 seconds, while the Epson RX630 took a leisurely 49 seconds to copy our coloured document. It got beaten by a small margin in the quality of the colour copy by the Epson RX630. The margin, however, was extremely small.

Conclusion

This was a no-brainer! The clear winner is the HP PhotoSmart 2608, given its reasonable pricing of Rs 15,000, and its performance as well—which is far superior to the other printers in this category. In fact, this device could have given the Lexmark X7170 a

run for its money. It has super copying abilities, extremely fine scanning abilities and its printing prowess is excellent. Though a bit of an ink guzzler—it printed 12 pages using 10 per cent of its ink as compared to 16 pages by the others—the category it is placed in is one where a few pages less don't really matter.



HP Photosmart 2608 All-in-one

Overall Conclusion

In the printer section, Canon blew the competition away with their latest range of Pixma printers. If you primarily need to print photographs, it would make more sense to go for one of the higher-end Pixmas than a mid-range MFD, although they have the disadvantage of not having a scanner. You could always click pictures of your document and print them!

In the MFD section, it was HP all the way. It was head and shoulders above the rest and stamped its authority across the category.

In the coming months, with manufacturers sure to launch new products to match and beat the Canons and the HPs, it's going to be an interesting battle. We will be in the thick of it... for you. Watch this space. ■

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